

With the Rajiv Gandhi Sea Link

we can see that Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's support to make Mumbai a modern city has borne fruit. His Government has been consistently providing the necessary support for the development of this city. Presently, infrastructure projects worth Rs. 25,000 crore are being carried out.

Chief Minister, Ashok Chavan

Industry, Investment

Maharashtra is the leading state in sectors of foreign direct investment and industries. The Special Economic Zones, Mega Projects, Information Technology and Bio-technology

are the areas where the state is in the forefront. This in turn has resulted in ample employment opportunities for the youth.

Various policies are being formulated to ensure Maharashtra's business-friendly atmosphere and investor-friendly policies. Amongst the 147 Mega projects approved 41 are in operational phase and 18 are already functional.

Due to these projects approximately 3.5 lakh jobs are expected to be created. Maharashtra has achieved the leading position amongst all other States in the field of Information Technology. It occupies numero-uno position in the country in setting up IT Parks and in adopting a Bio-Tech Policy in a determined bid to compete with other countries of the world. The government is planning a series of policy initiatives to woo corporate to set up their shops in Maharashtra. The Maharashtra government is offering infrastructure facilities in tier II cities like Nashik, Aurangabad, and Solapur.

FDI proposals approved in last 5 years	591
FDI expected	Rs. 26,489 crore
Projects approved by the Centre	3,540
Projects already functional	1,124
Investment in the Projects	Rs. 53,799 crore
Employment created through projects	2.48 lakh
IT Parks approved in the State	416
Private IT Parks within them	380
Investment in 63 approved IT Parks	Rs. 923 crore
Employment generated	1,41,786

E-Governance: Information Technology has been adopted widely and the government of Maharashtra has taken a number of e governance initiatives to improve the day-to-day functioning.

The state is building 7825 common service centers/IT Kiosks. There will be 1 Kiosks for 4 villages. weather forecast, market rates, water level and release dates from dams will be available there. Birth and death certificates, licence renewals, property and water tax payments can be taken care of there. All SETU centres can also issue NOCs and various licences. 43 offices of stamp duty and registrations have also been computerised.

The efforts made by the Maharashtra Government have been widely appreciated and SARITA has been recognised as the Best Revenue System and SETU as the Best Citizen Centric Project at the national level.



Pune: The Detroit of India

Education

The government believes that education should percolate to the bottom most strata of society and enable people to build a strong state. All the initiatives of the government reflect this ethos.



Ensuring education for all to empower their future

The Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan Scheme has been successful in taking education to grassroots. Its main aim is to make education accessible everywhere.

About 4 Lakh students who have stopped education for various reasons, have been lured back to school with incentives to their parents to ensure their attendance. An Accident allowance scheme of Rs. 2.24 crore has been put